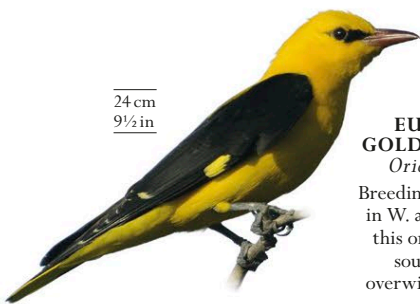


ORIOLES

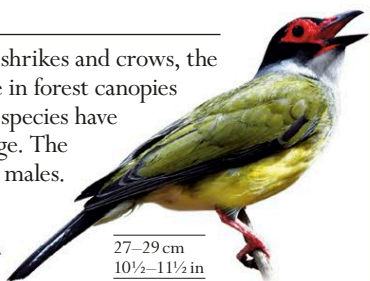
Old World passerines related to shrikes and crows, the birds of the family Oriolidae live in forest canopies and eat insects and fruits. Many species have striking yellow and black plumage. The females are usually greener than males.



24 cm
9½ in

EURASIAN GOLDEN ORIOLE *Oriolus oriolus*

Breeding in woodlands in W. and C. Eurasia, this oriole migrates southwards to overwinter in Africa.



27–29 cm
10½–11½ in

AUSTRALASIAN FIGBIRD *Sphecotheres vieilloti*

Stout-billed relatives of orioles from Australasia, figbirds are gregarious fruit-eaters. This species occurs in N. and E. Australia.

SHRIKES

The family Laniidae contains predators of open country. Many species store their prey (insects and small vertebrates) by impaling them on thorns. Most occur in Africa and Eurasia; two species live in North America.



17–18 cm
6½–7 in

RED-BACKED SHRIKE *Lanius collurio*

This bird breeds from Europe to Siberia and overwinters in Africa. Like other *Lanius* shrikes, it has a musical call.

BUSH-SHRIKES AND RELATIVES

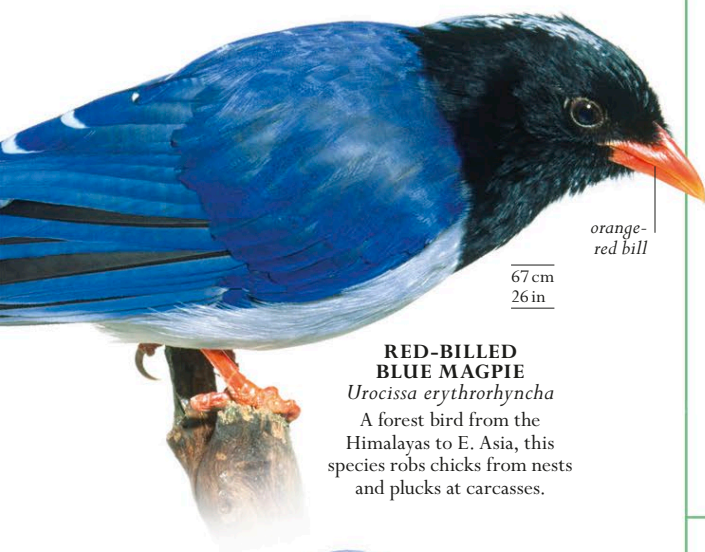
The family Malaconotidae is entirely confined to Africa. They are found mostly in scrubby, open woodland, and have a hooked bill for catching large insects.

CRIMSON-BREASTED GONOLEK *Laniarius atrococcineus*

Members of the African bush-shrike family, gonoleks have red and black plumage. This species occurs in southern Africa.



23 cm
9 in



RED-BILLED BLUE MAGPIE *Urocissa erythrorhyncha*

A forest bird from the Himalayas to E. Asia, this species robs chicks from nests and plucks at carcasses.

orange-red bill

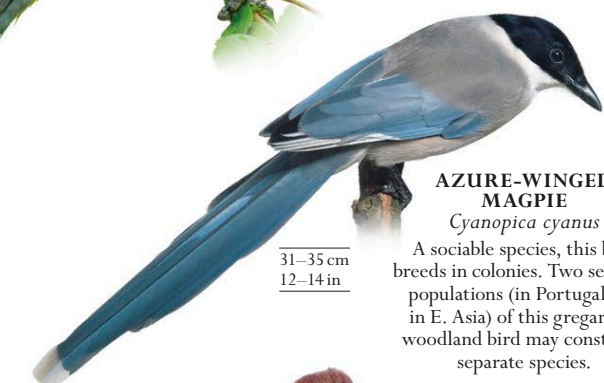
67 cm
26 in



29 cm
11½ in

GREEN JAY *Cyanocorax yncas*

This bird feeds on fruits and seeds. S. American populations of the green jay differ sufficiently from those of C. America to be considered as separate species.



31–35 cm
12–14 in

AZURE-WINGED MAGPIE *Cyanopica cyanus*

A sociable species, this bird breeds in colonies. Two separate populations (in Portugal and in E. Asia) of this gregarious woodland bird may constitute separate species.



34 cm
13½ in

EURASIAN JAY *Garrulus glandarius*

More closely related to Old World crows than American jays, this colourful woodland bird habitually hoards acorns in autumn.

DRONGOS

Black, long-tailed birds of Old World tropics, the Dicruridae sally for insects, bolting out suddenly to catch their prey. They are aggressive birds, and sometimes attack larger species to defend their nests.



26 cm
10 in

CRESTED DRONGO *Dicrurus forficatus*

Like other drongos, this Madagascan species has a long, forked tail and red eyes. It has a distinctive tuft of feathers at the base of its bill.

VANGAS AND RELATIVES

The predatory passerines of the family Vangidae include the helmet-shrikes of Africa and vangas from Madagascar. They feed on invertebrates, reptiles, and frogs, and have a range of bill shapes – chisel-, sickle-, and dagger-shaped – for different prey and feeding techniques.



20 cm
8 in

WHITE HELMET-SHRIKE *Prionops plumatus*

Widespread across sub-Saharan Africa, the white-crested helmet-shrike often gathers in small groups. This bird has a wide range of different calls.

RUFIOUS VANGA *Schetba rufa*

Common in the forests of Madagascar, this bird resembles a shrike, but is not closely related to the shrike family.



20 cm
8 in

WATTLE-EYES AND RELATIVES

The Platysteiridae, wattle-eyes and their relatives, form a family of insect-eating birds from Africa. They have a flat, hooked bill with bristles at the base. Like flycatchers, they snatch their prey suddenly.



13 cm
5 in

BROWN-THROATED WATTLE-EYE *Platysteira cyanea*

Wattle-eyes get their name from the red skin around their eyes. This common species occurs in woodland throughout sub-Saharan Africa.

VIREOS

Superficially resembling American warblers, but somewhat thicker-billed, the members of the family Vireonidae are more closely related to crows, and Old World orioles and shrikes. They take insects by gleaning or fly catching, and also eat some fruits.



11 cm
4¼ in

BLACK-CAPPED VIREO *Vireo atricapilla*

This species breeds in N. America and migrates to Mexico. Unlike other vireos, the sexes differ. The male is black-capped, while the female is grey-capped.



12–13 cm
4¾–5 in

RED-EYED VIREO *Vireo olivaceus*

N. American populations of this very vocal vireo migrate to S. America, where they join resident races of the same species.